

SEDAR 43 Gulf of Mexico Gray Triggerfish

1. Evaluate existing methods for deriving historical discard numbers and discard rates and improve methods as appropriate.
2. Develop/evaluate methods to maintain continuity of fishery-dependent indices in light of management regulations.
3. Develop a relationship between catchability of Gray Triggerfish on circle hooks when compared to J hooks.
4. Identify underlying factors resulting in discrepancies between recent estimates of cpue between the MRFSS Index and the SRHS Index.
5. Explore separating fisheries by gear, rather than by area.
6. Identify factors resulting in the release of fish in excess of size limits and improve estimates of asymptotic retention.